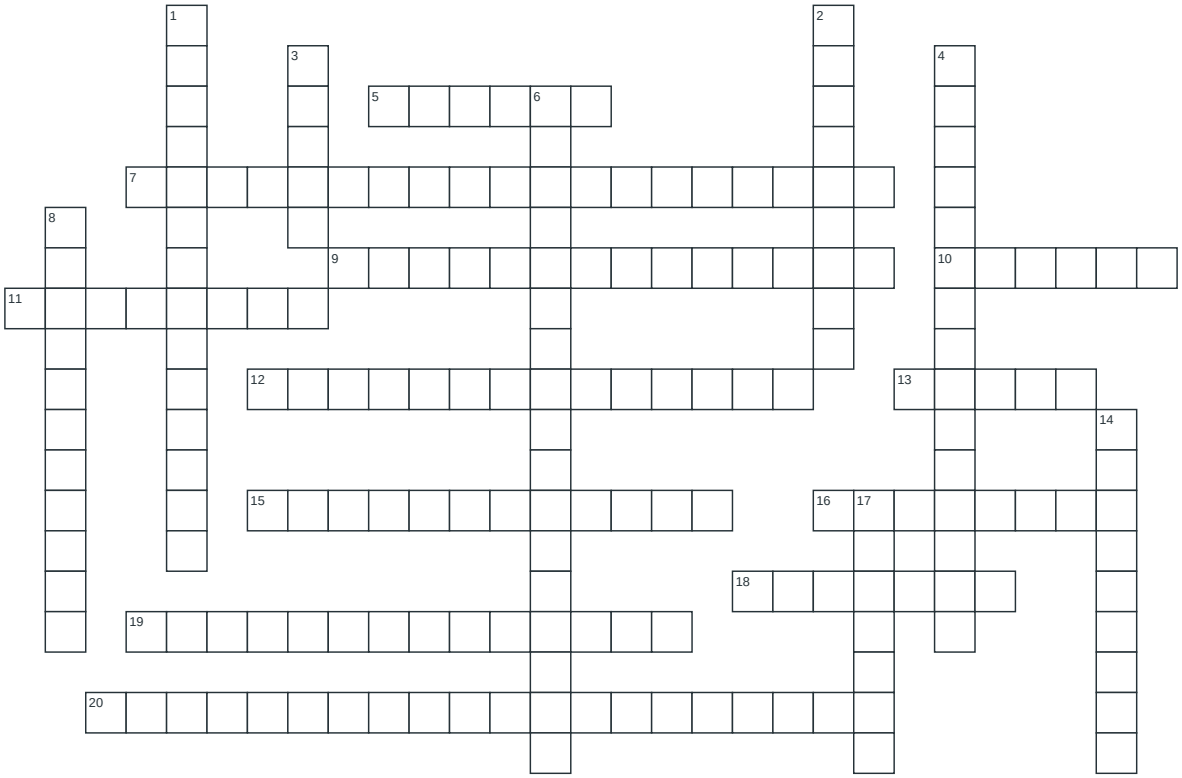
Classification and Taxonomy Crossword

Hard | 20 clues | Student Worksheet

Name: _____ Date: _____

Directions: Use the clues to complete the grid. Omit spaces, punctuation, and hyphens.



ACROSS

5. Broadest rank among the three levels in the common classification system.

7. Independent evolution of similar features in unrelated lineages.

9. An identification tool with paired choices

10. Rank lies between order and genus

11. Naming and classifying organisms

12. Organization of organisms into groups based on shared evidence.

13. Taxonomic rank grouping closely related species

15. Feature that evolved in a lineage and can help identify its descendants.

16. One of two domains containing prokaryotic organisms.

18. Group of organisms defined by a classification system; many can interbreed and produce fertile offspring.

19. Standardized name used to identify a species.

ACROSS (continued)

20. System that gives each species a two-part scientific name.

DOWN

1. Ancestral population shared by two or more groups.

2. Evolutionary history and relationships of organisms.

3. Animals share a family but have different genera. Which rank must they also share

4. Second part of a species' binomial name.

6. Tool that identifies organisms through a series of paired choices.

8. Location on a phylogenetic diagram representing a common ancestor.

14. Diagram showing proposed branching relationships among groups.

17. Domain of prokaryotes distinct from bacteria.

© 2026 Teach Arcade

Classification and Taxonomy Crossword

Hard | 20 clues | Teacher Answer Key

TEACHER ANSWER KEY

Completed grid and numbered answers. Spaces and punctuation are omitted in the grid.

ACROSS

5. Domain
7. Convergent evolution
9. Dichotomous Key
10. Family
11. Taxonomy
12. Classification
13. Genus
15. Derived trait
16. Bacteria
18. Species
19. Scientific name

ACROSS (continued)

20. Binomial nomenclature

DOWN

1. Common ancestor
2. Phylogeny
3. Order
4. Specific epithet
6. Identification key
8. Branch point
14. Cladogram
17. Archaea

© 2026 Teach Arcade